

Jagdish Kumar Ayer is the Founder and Executive Director of **Samanwaya Nepal**, a non-profit, youth-centered organization working at the intersection of youth empowerment, democratic governance, civic engagement, human rights, climate action, and sustainable development.

A recognized youth expert, policy advocate, and civic engagement specialist, Jagdish brings more than a decade of experience working with youth movements, civil society organizations, government institutions, and international networks. He has played a significant role in advancing youth participation in governance and public policy in Nepal and was a drafting member of Nepal's **National Youth Policy 2025**.

Throughout his career, Jagdish has designed and facilitated numerous training curricula and capacity-building programs on leadership, human rights, democracy, elections, civic participation, climate change, and youth empowerment, reaching thousands of young people across Nepal and internationally. He has also authored dozens of articles published in national newspapers and digital platforms on youth leadership, democracy, governance, and development issues.

Jagdish served as an **Executive Member of Nepal's National Youth Council (2021–2025)**, where he contributed to youth policy development, advocacy, and institutional strengthening. He currently serves as **Strategic Planning and Policy Advisor** to the **Association of Youth Organisations Nepal (AYON)** and previously served as its President. AYON is Nepal's largest national network of youth-led organizations, representing more than 90 member organizations across the country.

He is also the Founder President of the **Initiative for Civic Change Nepal (IFCC)** and has actively contributed to national policy processes, research, publications, and international dialogues on democracy, youth participation, peacebuilding, and sustainable development. Jagdish is a member and youth advisor to several global youth alliances and networks and currently serves as a member of the **Youth Democracy Network**.

In recognition of his contributions to youth leadership and sustainable development, Jagdish was honored with the **Youth Sustainability Promotion Award 2025**. He has represented Nepal at numerous international conferences, forums, and policy dialogues across Asia-Pacific, Europe, Australia, and North America, promoting youth leadership, democratic values, and inclusive development.

His work is driven by a commitment to strengthening democratic institutions, fostering inclusive governance, and creating meaningful opportunities for young people to become leaders and agents of social change.